TRAINER ANSWER KEY

Lab 5 – Management Insights

Suggested guidance for evaluating participant outputs. Risk labels are illustrative and should be justified from evidence.

Expected executive summary

The summary should state that the preliminary review identified several items requiring further verification, including the timing of the email and bids, the two POs and invoice, the vendor-contact match, and the procurement process. It should avoid stating that fraud, bid-rigging or conflict of interest has been established.

Risk indicators

Participants may identify the email/bid interaction, same-day POs, invoice/PO date sequence, vendor-contact match and price difference as indicators requiring review. A risk level should be accompanied by a clear reason and evidence ID. Where the evidence is insufficient, “Needs review” is acceptable.

6-slide outline – example

1) Executive Summary 2) Allegations & Scope 3) Key Evidence & Risk Indicators 4) Investigation Timeline 5) Open Questions & Evidence Gaps 6) Recommended Actions / Next Steps.

Follow-up email

The email should list practical next steps such as checking procurement records, validating PO/invoice dates, obtaining bid communications and evaluation records, and verifying the vendor-contact relationship. Owners and due dates should remain [TO CONFIRM] unless supplied by the Lab 4 material.

Core teaching point

Management communication should simplify the investigation without overstating it. Copilot can create the structure and draft, but the user must validate evidence, risk labels, owners and deadlines before circulation.